

# Creative industry exit planning — Action Checklist

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## AUDIT YOUR BURNOUT SOURCE

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- ☐ **Audit Your Burnout Source:** Create three separate columns labeling them project stress, role dysfunction, and industry-wide problems to diagnose where most of your suffering actually originates.
- ☐ **Audit Your Burnout Source:** Spend 30 minutes writing down specific examples of what you hate, placing each item in the appropriate column rather than keeping it vague and unexamined.
- ☐ **Audit Your Burnout Source:** Put checkmarks next to the five items in each column that feel most true on your worst days to identify your real non-negotiable pain points.
- ☐ **Audit Your Burnout Source:** Determine whether most of your pain lives in the industry column, which signals that no role within creative work will solve your burnout.

## IDENTIFY HIDDEN TRANSFERABLE SKILLS

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- ☐ **Identify Hidden Transferable Skills:** Break free from defining yourself as just a video editor by listing every tool, process, and workflow you use routinely in your current work.
- ☐ **Identify Hidden Transferable Skills:** Write out what you actually do all day beyond operating software, including how you translate vague direction into concrete technical results.
- ☐ **Identify Hidden Transferable Skills:** Identify instances where you manage competing priorities across multiple projects simultaneously, which represents a high-value skill businesses outside creative industries desperately need.
- ☐ **Identify Hidden Transferable Skills:** Recognize that your daily practice of making fast decisions under pressure is a sophisticated professional competency that applies far beyond the edit suite.

## PREPARE YOUR EXIT STRATEGY

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- ☐ **Prepare Your Exit Strategy:** Build a financial buffer before making any career changes so that desperation does not force you into another exploitative role out of immediate necessity.

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  - ☐ **Prepare Your Exit Strategy:** Research alternative roles and industries that your transferable skills could serve, focusing on sectors you have not previously considered as possibilities.

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  - ☐ **Prepare Your Exit Strategy:** Develop a transition plan that leverages your existing technical expertise instead of requiring you to start from zero in an entirely unfamiliar field.

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  - ☐ **Prepare Your Exit Strategy:** Create a timeline for your exit that protects your finances and professional identity while giving you space to make deliberate choices rather than panicked ones.
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